(c. 800 CE) wrote the *Vyomavati* on *Prashastapada*'s work, and this was followed by Shridhara's *Nyayakandali* (991 CE). ***Udayana*** (c. 1050–1100 CE) produced the *Kiranavali* and *Lakshanavali* and effectively unified the *Vaisheshika* metaphysics with the ***Nyaya*** tradition of logical analysis and theory of knowledge.

The system is realistic in that the entities falling under the categories (***padarthas***) are held to be objective realities that we discover. They are all existent, knowable and nameable: if not by us, by God. Knowledge reveals a world independent of subjectivity. These realists minimise the creativity of consciousness that they treat as the passive recipient of data about ready-made realities external to it. This involves treating relations, qualities, universal properties and even absences as entities.

Understanding the categories (***padartha***) is held to lead to ultimate well-being.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Cowell and Gough 1996; Ganeri 2001a; Halbfass 1992; Potter 1977

Vasana: Buddhist view that traces of past experiences, deliberate choices and actions linger in a stream of experiences that we call a person. They form a 'mind-set', a stock of concepts, conditioning what one decides, does and undergoes.

Vastubalapravritta-anumana (inference tracking objective reality): Buddhists following ***Dharmakirti*** think that conceptual thought and language are at a distance from reality as it is in itself. This is because the objective sphere of unique momentary particulars (***svalakshana***) causes sensory impressions that are converted into mental images, which are in turn interpreted and structured in concepts by the constructive mind. An inference such as 'Sound is